# When an AI video becomes a starting point

Markus Mak's yes& example shows how a video can be both a finished product and the starting point for another creator. The slides describe a creator who wants to turn a selfie into a short cinematic clip. The agent turns that idea into a video. A good clip solves that immediate problem. The idea I find more interesting is what happens next: can part of that clip help someone else make a different one? (Mak, slides 20–22.)

The Discover, Create and Reuse loop gives a feed a second purpose. Imagine finding a clip with a slow camera move that would work well for a product video. If the move is available as a reusable building block, a creator can try it with a new subject without guessing how the original was made. The original creator's work becomes more useful because other people can build on it. The same shortcut can also push the feed toward a handful of familiar styles. If most remixes look like their source, more activity could mean less variety.

I would test that distinction before investing in the marketplace mentioned in the slides. I would randomly split creators into two groups and give them the same starting feed and generation tools. Both groups could publish their own takes on a clip, but only one could reuse its building blocks directly. Over a week, I would compare how many creators in each group publish a remix or return on another day to create. I would use the same criteria to review samples from both groups for meaningful changes, such as using a camera move to tell a different story. Counting generated clips alone would reward a feature that is easy to click even if the results are too similar to be worth sharing.

The selfie example also shows where I would draw the line on reuse. Someone might be happy for others to borrow a camera move while wanting their face to stay out of other people's videos. I would let creators choose which elements to share and keep a visible link to the source when those elements are reused. That choice would make remixing slightly less automatic. I would accept that trade-off: the feed only has something worth building on if creators are willing to keep contributing work.

Source: Markus Mak, A Founder Journey, IS5542 Guest Lecture 5 slides, pp. 20–24.

I used OpenAI Codex to help draft and format this reflection.